JJJ-T-002208(Army-GL)
December 28, 1984

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TOMATOES, STEWED, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers stewed tomatoes thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 8915

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(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit; Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification for

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Tomatoes
U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Tomato Juice

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearney Street, No. 410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

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National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome and shall be as specified herein or in referenced documents.

3.2.1 Tomatoes, fresh. Fresh tomatoes shall be mature, red and of varieties that are suitable for canning. The tomatoes shall be ripe to the base, with a clear red color, and shall possess a good characteristic flavor and texture.

3.2.2 Tomato juice. Tomato juice shall be either fresh or canned or a combination thereof.

3.2.2.1 Tomato, juice, fresh. Fresh tomato juice shall be equal to or better than U.S. Grade A canned tomato juice.

3.2.2.2 Tomato juice, canned. Canned tomato juice shall be U.S. Grade A of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Tomato Juice.

3.2.3 Celery, sliced, freeze-dried. The freeze-dried celery shall be obtained from washed, trimmed, sound Pascal-type celery. The celery shall be cut transversely into 1/8 to 3/8 inch slices (with no leaf cuts), sulfited, freeze-dried, or partially air dried then freeze-dried. The celery shall be free flowing and possess an odor and flavor typical of fresh celery. The product shall reconstitute to a pale green to dark green color. The moisture content shall be not greater than 4 percent and the sulfite level shall be in the range of 500 to 1500 ppm as SO_2.

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3.2.4 Sugar. Sugar shall be clean, refined, sucrose, granulated cane or beet sugar or a combination thereof. The sugar shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride, with or without anticaking agents.

3.2.6 Onions, dehydrated, minced. The dehydrated minced onions shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.7 Peppers, green, dehydrated. The dehydrated green peppers shall possess a uniform bright green color, be dices (1/4 by 1/4 inch) made from mature sweet green or sweet-bell peppers and be free from damage caused by hail, sunburn, disease, insects or mechanical damage.

3.2.8 Calcium chloride. Calcium chloride shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Citric acid. Citric acid shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.10 Basil, whole. Whole basil shall be the dried leaves of Ocimum basilicum L., and shall possess a sweet, anise-like odor and aromatic, warm, slightly pungent flavor. The volatile oil content shall be not less than 0.4 mL/100g and the basil shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 35 sieve.

3.2.11 Oregano, whole. Whole oregano shall be the dried leaves of Oreganum vulgare L., and shall have a strong camphoraceous aroma and a pungent, slightly bitter flavor. The volatile oil content shall be not less than 2.0 mL/100 g.

3.2.12 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used provided the mixture complies with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same porportions as specified in the ingredient formulation.

3.2.13 Water. Water used for ice making, formulation, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

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3.3 Preparation and processing.

3.3.1 Tomato preparation. The tomatoes shall be washed, stemmed, peeled, cored, and uniformly sliced into approximately 5/8 inch slices. Juice produced during slicing may be included in the sauce as tomato juice.

3.3.2 Sauce preparation. The following ingredients shall be combined and mixed thoroughly.

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Tomato juice	70.07
Celery	7.20
Sugar	13.71
Salt	3.05
Onions, dehydrated, minced	2.62
Peppers, green, dehydrated	2.26
Calcium chloride	0.43
Citric acid	0.36
Basil	0.24
Oregano	0.06

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with sliced tomatoes (approximately 92 ounces) and sauce (approximately 18 ounces) such as to conform to the finished product requirements. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury immediately after filling.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at a temperature of 215° to 220°F until a minimum internal product temperature of 205°F is reached.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as, but not limited to dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor, such as, but not limited to burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

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d. No individual can shall contain less than 69 ounces drained weight of tomatoes and other vegetables.

e. The average net weight shall be not less than 110 ounces.

f. No individual can shall contain less than 108 ounces of product.

g. The pH shall be not less than 4.10 nor greater than 4.50.

h. The tomato slices shall be tender but not mushy.

i. The tomato slices shall retain their intended sliced style and appearance.

j. The vegetable pieces shall be firm in texture but not hard or mushy.

k. Tomatoes shall be U.S. Grade B in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grade of Canned Tomatoes.

l. The salt content of any individual tray pack shall not be less than 0.5 percent nor greater than 1.0 percent.

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting it to the USDA for any inspection.

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4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, vacuum sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

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4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 110 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 108 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be opened and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0-3200	8	-	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201-35000	13	-	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE II. Product inspection 1/ 2/ 3/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Drained weight of tomatoes and other vegetables less than 69 ounces. 4/
152	Tomato slice texture not tender (mushy).
153	Vegetable pieces not firm in texture (hard or mushy).
154	Tomato slices do not retain intended sliced style.

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts,hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ Product not meeting U.S. Grade B requirements in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Tomatoes shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4/ Drained weight shall be determined in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Tomatoes.

4.6.3 pH testing. Three trays shall be selected at random from the lot and individually tested for pH in accordance with the applicable chapter for pH determination of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.01. If the pH is less than 4.10 or greater than 4.50, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.4 Salt content testing. Nine tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot and distributed as follows:

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- Three for laboratory analysis.
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, except that preparation of the sample shall be as follows. The three cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if salt content in any individual tray pack is less than 0.5 percent or greater than 1.0 percent. Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the salt content requirement. When the reserve samples are analyzed, the analyses for salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used; (4) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box; (5) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (6) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 110 ounces of the food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirement. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

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5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimension of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of the product shall be permanently marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving. CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.
WARNING: Do not place closed can in oven as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

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YIELD

Approximately 25 servings of 1/2 cup each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should spe fy the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-A782

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
JJJ-T-002208(Army-GL)	Tomatoes, Stewed, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 20 Nov 84

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